Phase 10: The Church Is Born

Jesus goes back to heaven, the Holy Spirit comes like fire, and the good news spreads from Jerusalem to the ends of the earth.

At a Glance	
Month	Month 10
Books covered	Acts (1 book)
Bible section(s)	History–Acts (1)
Big Idea	The Holy Spirit gives God's people power to tell everyone about Jesus.
Memory Verse (all ages)	"But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you; and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth." — Acts 1:8 (NIV)
Little Lambs verse	"You will be my witnesses." — Acts 1:8
Theme color	Flame Red (with a touch of orange)
Phase symbol / badge	🔥 The Spirit Flame badge (a red-orange flame with a small globe inside it)
Running total of books learned	**44 of 66**

> Cross-links: Program Overview · Teacher Training Guide · Books of the Bible Memory System · Game Library · YouTube Video Guide · Phase 10 Printables

The Big Idea (in kid words)

Jesus came back to life, and then He went back up to heaven. But He did not leave His friends alone. He sent the Holy Spirit — God Himself — to live inside everyone who trusts Jesus. The Holy Spirit made scared people brave and gave them power to tell everyone the good news. That group of Jesus-followers is called **the church** — and if you love Jesus, you are part of it too!

How this points to Jesus: The book of Acts is really "Part 2" of what Jesus did. Luke wrote that his first book (the Gospel of Luke) told what Jesus *began* to do and teach (Acts 1:1). Acts shows Jesus *still* working — from heaven, through His Spirit, through His people. Every healing in Acts happens "in the name of Jesus," every sermon is about Jesus dying and rising, and the whole book ends with Paul "proclaiming the kingdom of God and teaching about the Lord Jesus Christ" (Acts 28:31).

The Books in Easy Words

Acts (The Acts of the Apostles)

How to say it	AKTS (rhymes with "facts")
How to spell it	Acts — A-C-T-S (one syllable, one clap!)
Full title	The Acts of the Apostles ("a-POS-uls" = "sent-out ones")
Section	History–Acts (the only book in this section) — the New Testament's history book
Traditional author	Luke, a doctor and Paul's travel friend (he also wrote the Gospel of Luke). Both books are written to a man named Theophilus (thee-OFF-ih-lus).
When	The events cover about 30 years (around AD 30–62).
One-sentence kid summary	After Jesus goes back to heaven, the Holy Spirit fills His followers with power, and they tell the good news about Jesus everywhere — from Jerusalem all the way to Rome.
In one word	**GO!** (or "Spread!")
Key people	Peter, John, Stephen, Philip, Saul/Paul, Barnabas, Silas, Timothy, Lydia, Cornelius, Priscilla & Aquila, Luke
Key stories	Jesus goes up to heaven (ch. 1) · Pentecost: wind and fire (ch. 2) · Peter and John heal a man who could not walk (ch. 3) · Stephen, the first Christian to die for Jesus (ch. 6–7) · Philip and the Ethiopian official (ch. 8) · Saul meets Jesus on the road to Damascus (ch. 9) · Peter and Cornelius (ch. 10) · An angel breaks Peter out of jail (ch. 12) · Paul's missionary journeys (ch. 13–21) · Paul and Silas sing in jail (ch. 16) · Shipwreck and a snake bite (ch. 27–28)
Where Jesus shows up	Jesus speaks and ascends (1:1–11); Peter preaches that Jesus is "Lord and Messiah" (2:36); Stephen sees Jesus standing at God's right hand (7:55–56); Jesus speaks to Saul from heaven: "I am Jesus, whom you are persecuting" (9:5); Jesus encourages Paul at night: "Take courage!" (23:11)
Hand motion / picture symbol	🔥 **Flame & Go:** Wiggle your fingers above your head like a flame (the Spirit), then throw both hands forward like you're tossing seeds to the world (spreading the good news). Say "ACTS!" as you throw.

Acts in four "rings" (Acts 1:8 is the map of the whole book):

1. **Jerusalem** — chapters 1–7
2. **Judea & Samaria** — chapters 8–12
3. **The ends of the earth** — chapters 13–28 (Paul's journeys to Turkey, Greece, and finally Rome)

Teacher Preparation

Background for the teacher

Acts is the bridge between the Gospels and the Letters. Without it, we would not know how Paul became an apostle, who the churches in Corinth, Philippi, and Ephesus were, or how a small Jewish movement in Jerusalem became a worldwide family including Gentiles (non-Jews). Luke was a careful historian (Luke 1:1–4), and he was an eyewitness for parts of the story — notice the "we" sections starting in Acts 16:10, where Luke travels with Paul.

The book has two main human "heroes": **Peter** (chapters 1–12, mostly among Jewish people) and **Paul** (chapters 13–28, mostly among Gentiles). But the true main character is the **Holy Spirit**, who is mentioned over 50 times. The Spirit is not a "force" or an "it"; He is God, the third person of the Trinity, who comforts, guides, and empowers believers.

Key truths to emphasize

1. **Jesus is alive and reigning.** The ascension is not Jesus "leaving"; it's Jesus taking His throne.
2. **The Holy Spirit lives in every believer** (Acts 2:38–39). Kids who trust Jesus have the Spirit too — this isn't just for grown-ups or "super Christians."
3. **The church is people, not a building.** The first church met in homes (Acts 2:46).
4. **The gospel is for everyone** — every nation, language, and background (Acts 10:34–35).
5. **God's plan can't be stopped.** Jail, threats, storms, and shipwrecks could not stop the message (Acts 28:31 ends with "without hindrance").

Timeline & map notes

- **AD 30/33** — Jesus' death, resurrection, ascension, and Pentecost (Pentecost = 50 days after Passover; Jesus ascended 40 days after rising, Acts 1:3).
- **~AD 34–36** — Stephen martyred; Saul's conversion.
- **~AD 46–48** — Paul's 1st journey (Cyprus and southern Turkey: Antioch in Pisidia, Iconium, Lystra, Derbe).
- **~AD 49** — Jerusalem Council (Acts 15).
- **~AD 49–52** — 2nd journey (Philippi, Thessalonica, Berea, Athens, Corinth).
- **~AD 53–57** — 3rd journey (long stay in Ephesus).
- **~AD 57–62** — Arrest in Jerusalem, prison in Caesarea, voyage and shipwreck, house arrest in Rome.

Map tip: Draw three loops on a big map of the Mediterranean (blue = 1st journey, green = 2nd, orange = 3rd) and a red dotted line for the trip to Rome. Trailblazers love tracing these.

Handling sensitive content by age

Topic	Little Lambs (4–6)	Explorers (7–10)	Trailblazers & Ambassadors (11–17)
Stephen's death (Acts 7)	"Some angry people hurt Stephen very badly, and he died. But Jesus was right there, and Stephen went to be with Jesus." No details of stoning.	"They threw stones at him." Focus on Stephen forgiving them like Jesus did.	Discuss persecution then and now; Stephen's prayer mirrors Jesus' on the cross (Luke 23:34).
Ananias & Sapphira (Acts 5)	Skip.	Optional; emphasize "God cares about honesty."	Discuss God's holiness and why lying to the Holy Spirit was so serious in the newborn church.
Saul hurting Christians (Acts 8–9)	"Saul was mean to Jesus' friends."	"He put Christians in jail."	Discuss real forgiveness: God can change anyone.
Beatings, jail, shipwreck	Keep calm and hopeful: "God took care of them."	Fine to tell plainly; highlight courage and joy.	Discuss suffering for faith and why it doesn't mean God has abandoned us.

Common kid questions (with simple answers)

- **"Where did Jesus go?"** — Up to heaven, to be with God the Father. He is alive right now, and He is coming back one day (Acts 1:11).
- **"Is the Holy Spirit a ghost?"** — No. The old word "Holy Ghost" just meant "Holy Spirit." He is God, and He is kind, good, and with us.
- **"Can I see the Holy Spirit?"** — Not with our eyes, like we can't see wind. But we can see what He does — like how wind moves the trees, the Spirit changes people's hearts.
- **"Will I get fire on my head?"** — The flames on Pentecost were a special sign for that day. The Spirit doesn't usually come with flames, but He comes to everyone who trusts Jesus.
- **"Why did God let Stephen die?"** — We don't know every reason. But God was with Stephen, Stephen went to be with Jesus, and God used what happened to spread the good news to new places (Acts 8:4).
- **"Can God change a really mean person?"** — Yes! Saul was one of the meanest enemies of Christians, and God changed him into Paul, one of the greatest missionaries ever.
- **"Am I in the church?"** — If you trust Jesus, yes! The church is God's family, and you belong.

Month at a Glance

Week	Passage	Lesson Title	Key Point	Video	Game	Activity
1	Acts 1–2	Wind, Fire & Power!	Jesus went up; the Holy Spirit came down.	📺 Pentecost (Sharefaith Kids, Bible Journey); "Overview: Acts 1–12" (BibleProject)	🎮 Wind Relay	Pentecost Flame Headbands
2	Acts 3–4; 6–7	Brave in Jesus' Name	The Spirit makes us brave to speak about Jesus.	📺 Peter & John heal the lame man; Stephen	🎮 Silver & Gold Freeze	"In Jesus' Name" Walking Feet Craft
3	Acts 8:26–40; 9:1–31; 10	From Enemy to Friend	God can change anyone, and the good news is for everyone.	📺 Saul's conversion; Peter's vision	🎮 Road to Damascus Blindfold Walk	Scales-Falling Paper Glasses
4	Acts 13–14; 16; 27–28	To the Ends of the Earth	Nothing can stop God's good news.	📺 Paul & Silas in prison; the shipwreck; "Overview: Acts 13–28" (BibleProject)	🎮 Shipwreck!	Missionary Journey Map & Passport
5 (optional)	Review all of Acts	Review & Fun Sunday	44 books and counting!	Favorite clip replay	🎮 Acts Trivia Ship Race	Spirit Flame Badge ceremony

📅 2nd & 4th Sunday Plan

Our class meets on the **2nd and 4th Sundays** of each month, so the four lessons below are taught **two at a time**. Each Sunday is still 75 minutes, with two shorter stories. Use the full lesson write-ups in **Weekly Lessons** for scripts, questions and supplies.

Sunday	2027 date*	Teach	Big takeaway
2nd Sunday	Oct 10	**Lesson 1: "Wind, Fire & Power!"** (Acts 1–2) + **Lesson 2: "Brave in Jesus' Name"** (Acts 3–4; 6–7)	Jesus went up; the Holy Spirit came down. The Spirit makes us brave to speak about Jesus.
4th Sunday	Oct 24	**Lesson 3: "From Enemy to Friend"** (Acts 8:26–40; 9:1–31; 10) + **Lesson 4: "To the Ends of the Earth"** (Acts 13–14; 16; 27–28) + **End-of-Phase Review**	God can change anyone, and the good news is for everyone. Nothing can stop God's good news.

**Dates assume a January 2027 start. See the Program Overview for the full calendar.*

2nd Sunday: "Wind, Fire & Power!" + "Brave in Jesus' Name"

Time	Segment	What to do
0:00–0:08	🎵 Welcome & Book Chant	Attendance, then sing this phase's book song with motions.
0:08–0:20	📖 Story 1	**Wind, Fire & Power!** (Acts 1–2). Use the Lesson 1 hook and story script. Key point: *Jesus went up; the Holy Spirit came down.*
0:20–0:28	📺 Video	Show **one** video (Little Lambs & Explorers: Sharefaith Kids; Trailblazers & Ambassadors: BibleProject). Options: Pentecost (Sharefaith Kids, Bible Journey); "Overview: Acts 1–12" (BibleProject). Send the others home on the family page.
0:28–0:40	📖 Story 2	**Brave in Jesus' Name** (Acts 3–4; 6–7). Use the Lesson 2 script. Key point: *The Spirit makes us brave to speak about Jesus.*
0:40–0:48	💬 Small Groups	Ask 1 question from Lesson 1 and 1 from Lesson 2 for your age group, then: "Where did we see Jesus today?"
0:48–0:58	🎮 Game	**Wind Relay** (Lesson 1). Backup: Silver & Gold Freeze.
0:58–1:10	🖍️ Activity	**"In Jesus' Name" Walking Feet Craft** (Lesson 2). Early finishers: this phase's coloring page or word search.
1:10–1:15	✅ Memory, Spelling & Prayer	Say the memory verse, spell 1–2 new books together, give stars, and pray. Send home the Take-Home Family Page.

4th Sunday: "From Enemy to Friend" + "To the Ends of the Earth"

Time	Segment	What to do
0:00–0:08	🎵 Welcome & Book Chant	Attendance, then sing this phase's book song with motions. Then a 2-minute recap: "What do you remember from last time?"
0:08–0:20	📖 Story 1	**From Enemy to Friend** (Acts 8:26–40; 9:1–31; 10). Use the Lesson 3 hook and story script. Key point: *God can change anyone, and the good news is for everyone.*
0:20–0:28	📺 Video	Show **one** video (Little Lambs & Explorers: Sharefaith Kids; Trailblazers & Ambassadors: BibleProject). Options: Saul's conversion; Peter's vision. Send the others home on the family page.
0:28–0:40	📖 Story 2	**To the Ends of the Earth** (Acts 13–14; 16; 27–28). Use the Lesson 4 script. Key point: *Nothing can stop God's good news.*
0:40–0:48	💬 Small Groups	Ask 1 question from Lesson 3 and 1 from Lesson 4 for your age group, then: "Where did we see Jesus today?"
0:48–0:56	🎮 Game	**Road to Damascus Blindfold Walk** (Lesson 3). Backup: Shipwreck!.
0:56–1:04	🖍️ Activity	**Missionary Journey Map & Passport** (Lesson 4). Early finishers: this phase's coloring page or word search.

Time	Segment	What to do
1:04–1:15	✅ Review, Passport & Prayer	Run the **End-of-Phase** oral check-offs by age group, stamp Bible Passports, hand out the phase badge, and pray. Anyone not finished can check off on the next 2nd Sunday.

🏠 Between Sundays (the 1st and 3rd weeks)

Kids go two weeks between classes, so the home weeks keep the memory work going. Put these on the family page or text them to parents:

- **After the 2nd Sunday:** Sing the book song once a day, practice this phase's spelling words (5 minutes), read or listen to Acts 1–2 and Acts 3–4; 6–7 with a picture Bible, and watch the video the class didn't see.
- **After the 4th Sunday:** Read Acts 13–14; 16; 27–28 together, talk through the 3 dinner-table questions, and keep singing the whole song so far. The next phase starts on the 2nd Sunday!
- **Teachers:** A quick text or photo to parents mid-week ("This week, practice spelling ___!") makes a big difference.

✂️ What to Trim When Time Is Short

Two lessons in one Sunday means you **won't use everything** in the Weekly Lessons. Keep these, in this order: (1) both story scripts, (2) the memory verse and book song, (3) one game, (4) one activity. Extra games, crafts, trivia and puzzles become take-home pages, early-finisher options or fun for a 5th-Sunday or special event.

> 💡 **Optional bonus:** "Review & Fun Sunday" (the old Week 5 review) can be used for a special event, a 5th Sunday if your church holds class, or folded into the 4th Sunday's review time.

Weekly Lessons

> 📅 **Twice a month:** The four lessons below are taught in pairs: **Lessons 1 & 2 on the 2nd Sunday**, **Lessons 3 & 4 on the 4th Sunday**. See the 2nd & 4th Sunday Plan above for the 75-minute run sheets. "Week 1–4" below means Lesson 1–4.

Week 1 — Wind, Fire & Power! (Acts 1–2)

Scripture: Acts 1:1–11; 2:1–41 **Lesson goal:** Kids will know that Jesus went back to heaven and sent the Holy Spirit to give His followers power to tell others about Him.

Opening hook / object lesson — "The Invisible Helper" *Supplies:* a small handheld fan (or a sheet of cardboard), a pinwheel, a few tissues or feathers, an uninflated balloon.

1. Ask, "Can you see wind?" (No.) Turn on the fan and point it at the pinwheel. "Can you see what the wind DOES?" (Yes!)
2. Blow up the balloon a little: "Air inside makes it big and strong." Let it go and watch it zoom.
3. Say: "Today we'll learn about Someone we can't see with our eyes — the Holy Spirit. Like wind, we see what He does. He fills people and gives them power!"

Story script (read aloud):

> After Jesus came back to life, He spent forty days with His friends. He ate with them, talked with them, and taught them about God's kingdom. Then one day, on a hill called the Mount of Olives, Jesus gave them a big job.
>
> "Wait in Jerusalem," Jesus said. "Soon the Holy Spirit will come on you, and you will get power. Then you will be My witnesses — in Jerusalem, in Judea and Samaria, and all the way to the ends of the earth!" A witness is someone who tells what they have seen.
>
> And then — whoosh! — Jesus went up, up, up into the sky until a cloud hid Him. His friends stood there staring. Suddenly two men dressed in white stood beside them. "Why are you looking at the sky?" they said. "This same Jesus will come back the same way you saw Him go!"
>
> So the friends went back to Jerusalem and prayed together and waited. Ten days later, it was a big holiday called Pentecost. Jerusalem was crowded with people from many countries. Jesus' friends were all together in one place.
>
> Suddenly, a sound like a mighty, rushing wind filled the whole house! Then something that looked like little flames of fire came and rested on each person. They were all filled with the Holy Spirit — and they began to speak in other languages they had never learned!
>
> People outside heard the noise and came running. "How can this be?" they said. "These men are from Galilee, but we hear them telling about God's wonders in our own languages!"
>
> Then Peter stood up. Remember Peter? Not long before, he had been so scared that he said three times he didn't even know Jesus. But now, filled with the Holy Spirit, Peter was brave! He shouted, "Jesus, the One you put on a cross, God raised back to life! We have all seen Him! God has made Him both Lord and Messiah!"
>
> The people's hearts hurt. "What should we do?" they asked. Peter said, "Turn away from your sins and be baptized in the name of Jesus. God will forgive you, and you will receive the Holy Spirit too!"
>
> That day, about three thousand people believed in Jesus and were baptized. The church was born — and it was just getting started!

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Make sound effects together: rub hands for wind, wiggle fingers for flames. Repeat: "Jesus went UP (point up), the Spirit came DOWN (wiggle fingers down)."

- **Explorers:** Have them count to 40 (days with Jesus) and then 10 more (waiting) = 50 = Pentecost ("Pente" means fifty). Practice spelling A-C-T-S with claps.
- **Trailblazers:** Compare Babel (Genesis 11 — languages confused, people scattered) and Pentecost (languages understood, people united in Jesus). Look up Acts 2:9–11 and find the countries on a map.
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss Peter's transformation (Luke 22:54–62 vs. Acts 2:14). What changed him? Read Acts 2:42–47 and compare that church to ours today. Have one Ambassador lead the Little Lambs' sound-effect retelling.

Discussion questions

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Where did Jesus go? (Up to heaven.) 2) Who did Jesus send to help His friends? (The Holy Spirit.) 3) What did it sound like? (Wind!)
- *Explorers:* 1) What job did Jesus give His friends? 2) What did the people from other countries hear? 3) How was Peter different from the night Jesus was arrested?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) Why do you think God let people hear the message in their own languages? 2) Acts 1:8 lists four places — what does that tell us about God's plan? 3) What does a "witness" do, and how can you be one at school?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) Peter said, "God has made this Jesus… both Lord and Messiah" (2:36). Why are those two titles so important? 2) What do Acts 2:42–47's four habits (teaching, fellowship, breaking bread, prayer) look like in a teenager's life? 3) Why does it matter that the Holy Spirit is a Person and not just a power?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "Pentecost" / "Holy Spirit comes" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Pentecost | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Pentecost" / "Ascension" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Pentecost | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors (Explorers with pauses) | "Overview: Acts 1–12" (also the theme video "Holy Spirit") | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Acts |

Teacher: Preview every video before class. Follow-up questions: 1) What surprised you in the video? 2) What did the people do after Peter preached?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Wind Relay* (see Games). ✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Pentecost Flame Headbands* (see Activities & Crafts). 🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Say the full memory verse with motions. Spell A-C-T-S. Add "Acts" to the end of the Gospels chant: "Matthew, Mark, Luke, John — ACTS!" 🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> "Dear God, thank You that Jesus is alive in heaven. Thank You for sending the Holy Spirit. Please make me brave to tell others about Jesus. Amen."

Week 2 — Brave in Jesus' Name (Acts 3–4; 6–7)

Scripture: Acts 3:1–10; 4:1–31; 6:8–15; 7:54–60 **Lesson goal:** Kids will learn that the Holy Spirit gives courage to speak about Jesus, even when it's hard.

Opening hook / object lesson — "What Do I Have?" *Supplies:* an empty wallet or purse, a few play coins, a small wrapped "gift" box with a paper heart inside labeled "JESUS."

1. Open the wallet and dump out the coins. "Is money a good gift? Sure! But today we'll meet two men who had *no* money."
2. Hold up the box: "They had something better to give." Open it and show the heart.
3. Say: "Peter said, 'Silver or gold I do not have, but what I do have I give you.' Let's find out what he gave!"

Story script:

> One afternoon, Peter and John walked to the temple to pray. By the gate called Beautiful sat a man who had never been able to walk — not even once since the day he was born. He was over forty years old! Every day, friends carried him to the gate so he could beg for money.
>
> "Please, give me some money!" the man called. Peter and John stopped and looked right at him. "Look at us!" Peter said. The man looked up, hoping for coins.
>
> But Peter said, "Silver or gold I do not have, but what I do have I give you. In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, walk!" Peter took his hand and helped him up — and instantly the man's feet and ankles became strong! He jumped up, stood, and walked. Then he went into the temple walking and jumping and praising God!
>
> Everyone stared. "Isn't that the man who used to sit by the gate?" Peter told them, "Why are you surprised? We didn't do this by our own power. Jesus did it! The same Jesus you killed — God raised Him from the dead!"
>
> The leaders were angry. They put Peter and John in jail overnight. The next day they said, "Stop talking about Jesus!" But Peter and John answered, "We cannot help speaking about what we have seen and heard." Then they went back to their friends, and everyone prayed, "Lord, help us speak Your word with great boldness." The place where they were shook, and they were all filled with the Holy Spirit again!
>
> More and more people believed. One of the church's helpers was a man named Stephen. He was full of God's grace and power. Some people hated what Stephen said about Jesus, so they dragged him in front of the leaders. Stephen bravely told them the whole story of God's people — and how they had rejected Jesus.
>
> The leaders grew furious. But Stephen looked up to heaven and said, "Look! I see heaven open and Jesus standing at the right hand of God!" They dragged him outside the city and threw stones at him. As he was dying, Stephen prayed, "Lord Jesus, receive my spirit... Lord, do not hold this sin

> against them." Just like Jesus, Stephen forgave the people who hurt him. And then he went to be with Jesus forever.

(Little Lambs version of the ending: "Some angry people hurt Stephen very badly. But Stephen saw Jesus in heaven, and he forgave them, and he went to be with Jesus.")

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Act out the lame man: sit on the floor, then on "In the name of Jesus — walk!" everyone jumps up and hops around praising God. Repeat three times; they will beg for more.
- **Explorers:** Hold a "Brave Meter" (thermometer drawn on poster). Ask: "When is it hard to talk about Jesus?" Color up the meter as they share ideas for being brave.
- **Trailblazers:** Compare Stephen's last words (7:59–60) to Jesus' on the cross (Luke 23:34, 46). Why would Luke include these similarities?
- **Ambassadors:** Read Acts 4:13 — the leaders saw that Peter and John were "unschooled, ordinary men" and "took note that these men had been with Jesus." Discuss: courage comes from time with Jesus, not from being impressive. Note that Saul (later Paul) watched Stephen die (7:58; 8:1) — foreshadowing next week.

Discussion questions

- *Little Lambs:* 1) What did the man do after Jesus healed him? (Walked and jumped!) 2) Whose name did Peter use? (Jesus.) 3) Who did Stephen see in heaven? (Jesus.)
- *Explorers:* 1) Why didn't Peter give the man money? 2) What did Peter and John say when they were told to stop talking about Jesus? 3) How was Stephen like Jesus?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) Why did the healing make the leaders angry instead of happy? 2) What did the believers pray for in Acts 4:29 — and what didn't they pray for? 3) What's one hard place where you need courage to follow Jesus?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) The believers prayed for boldness, not safety. What does that teach us about prayer? 2) How can you forgive someone who mistreats you for your faith? 3) Stephen's death led to the gospel spreading (8:1–4). How has God brought good out of hard things in history or in your life?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "Peter and John heal" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Peter+and+John | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Stephen" / "lame man healed" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Stephen | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | "Overview: Acts 1–12" (rewatch the Jerusalem section) or "Gospel of the Kingdom" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Gospel+of+the+Kingdom |

Teacher: Preview every video before class. Follow-up questions: 1) How did the man show he was thankful? 2) Where did Peter say the power came from?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Silver & Gold Freeze* (see Games). ✂️ **Activity of the week:** *"In Jesus' Name" Walking Feet Craft* (see Activities & Crafts). 🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Memory verse through "...and

you will be my witnesses." Spell A-C-T-S and A-P-O-S-T-L-E-S (Explorers and up). Recite all four Gospels + Acts. 🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> "Jesus, You are powerful! Please give me courage to talk about You. Help me forgive people, like Stephen did. Amen."

Week 3 — From Enemy to Friend (Acts 8:26–40; 9:1–31; 10)

Scripture: Acts 8:26–40; 9:1–31; 10:1–48 **Lesson goal:** Kids will learn that God can change anyone's heart and that the good news is for every person, everywhere.

Opening hook / object lesson — "Dirty to Clean" *Supplies:* a clear glass of water, a few drops of food coloring (dark blue), a small bottle of bleach-free stain remover or a few drops of household iodine + vitamin C tablet (adult-handled; the classic "disappearing color" trick), OR simply a dirty T-shirt and a clean T-shirt.

- Simple version: Show a muddy shirt. "Could this ever be clean again?" Then hold up the same style shirt, clean. "God can make a brand-new person out of someone who was really, really wrong."
- Say: "Today you'll meet a man named Saul who hated Jesus' friends. Could God ever change *him*?"

Story script:

> After Stephen died, a young man named Saul got angrier and angrier at the people who followed Jesus. He went from house to house, dragging Christians to jail. Then he asked for letters so he could arrest Jesus-followers in the city of Damascus too.
>
> Saul and his men were on the road, almost to Damascus, when suddenly — FLASH! — a light from heaven, brighter than the noon sun, blazed all around him. Saul fell to the ground. A voice said, "Saul, Saul, why do you persecute Me?"
>
> "Who are You, Lord?" Saul asked, trembling.
>
> "I am Jesus, whom you are persecuting," the voice answered. "Now get up and go into the city, and you will be told what to do."
>
> Saul stood up and opened his eyes — but he couldn't see anything! He was blind. His men had to lead him by the hand into Damascus. For three days Saul couldn't see, and he didn't eat or drink. He just prayed.
>
> In Damascus there was a believer named Ananias. Jesus told him in a vision, "Go to Saul and pray for him." Ananias gulped. "Lord, this man has done terrible things to Your people!" But Jesus said, "Go! I have chosen him to tell the nations about Me."

> So Ananias went. He put his hands on Saul and said, "Brother Saul" — brother! — "Jesus sent me so you can see again and be filled with the Holy Spirit." Right away, something like scales fell from Saul's eyes. He could see! He got up and was baptized.
>
> Saul began telling everyone, "Jesus is the Son of God!" Now people wanted to hurt *him*. One night his friends put him in a big basket and lowered him through an opening in the city wall so he could escape. Later, Saul became known by his other name — Paul — and he became one of the greatest missionaries who ever lived.
>
> Meanwhile, God was teaching Peter something new too. A Roman soldier named Cornelius loved God, and an angel told him to send for Peter. At the same time, Peter had a vision of a big sheet full of animals, and God said, "Do not call anything impure that God has made clean." When Peter met Cornelius and his family, he understood: "God does not show favoritism!" The good news of Jesus is for everybody — every nation, every color, every language. And the Holy Spirit came on Cornelius's whole household too!

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Turn the lights off for "blind" and on when the "scales fall off." Say together: "Jesus can change ANYONE!" Hold up a heart that flips from a frowny face to a smiley face.
- **Explorers:** Point out Saul = Paul: same man, two names (Saul was his Hebrew name; Paul his Roman name — Acts 13:9). Let them spell both.
- **Trailblazers:** Look up Acts 9:15 and Galatians 1:13–16 — Paul's own description of his change. Map Jerusalem → Damascus (about 135 miles / 220 km).
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss why Cornelius's story was such a big deal: the first church was mostly Jewish, and including Gentiles without them becoming Jewish first was a major step (Acts 10–11; 15). Discuss Ananias's courage — would you visit someone who was known to hurt Christians?

Discussion questions

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Who talked to Saul from heaven? (Jesus.) 2) What happened to Saul's eyes? (He couldn't see, then he could!) 3) Can Jesus change anybody? (Yes!)
- *Explorers:* 1) Why was Ananias afraid to visit Saul? 2) How did Saul escape from Damascus? 3) What did Peter learn from Cornelius?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) Jesus said Saul was persecuting *Me*. What does that tell us about how Jesus feels about His people? 2) Why do you think Ananias called him "Brother Saul"? 3) Who is someone you think could "never" change? Pray for them this week.
- *Ambassadors:* 1) Paul later called himself "the worst of sinners" (1 Timothy 1:15–16). How does his story give hope to others? 2) What does "God does not show favoritism" (10:34) mean for racism or cliques today? 3) What does true conversion look like — a feeling, a decision, a changed life, or all of these?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "Saul conversion" / "Road to Damascus" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Saul | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Paul conversion" / "Philip and the Ethiopian" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Paul | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers &

Ambassadors | "Overview: Acts 1–12" (Samaria to Cornelius part) | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Acts |

Teacher: Preview every video before class. Follow-up questions: 1) How did Saul change after meeting Jesus? 2) Who helped Saul after he was blinded?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Road to Damascus Blindfold Walk* (see Games). ✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Scales-Falling Paper Glasses* (see Activities & Crafts). 🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Full memory verse; spell S-A-U-L and P-A-U-L. Recite all 44 books with the cumulative chant (big kids) or the Gospels + Acts (little kids). 🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> "Jesus, thank You that You can change anyone — even me! Help me love everyone, because Your good news is for everybody. Amen."

Week 4 — To the Ends of the Earth (Acts 13–14; 16; 27–28)

Scripture: Acts 13:1–3; 16:6–40; 27:1–28:31 **Lesson goal:** Kids will learn that God sent Paul around the world with the good news, and nothing — not jail, storms, or snakes — could stop it.

Opening hook / object lesson — "Can't Stop It!" *Supplies:* a roll of masking tape, a small ball, a paper "message" taped to the ball reading "JESUS IS ALIVE!"

1. Lay tape lines on the floor as "walls." Roll the ball; let kids try to block it with their hands, but have a teacher keep finding new ways around.
2. Say: "Some people tried to stop the message about Jesus. They tried jail. They tried chains. Even a giant storm tried! But God's message kept rolling."

Story script:

> In the city of Antioch, the church was praying when the Holy Spirit said, "Set apart Barnabas and Saul for the work I have called them to." So the church prayed for them and sent them off. That was the first missionary journey! A missionary is someone sent to tell others about Jesus.
>
> Paul went on three big journeys, walking and sailing thousands of miles. On his second trip, he took his friend Silas. They went to a city called Philippi. There a woman named Lydia, who sold fancy purple cloth, believed in Jesus. But some men got angry at Paul and Silas, and they had them beaten and thrown into the deepest part of the jail with their feet locked in wooden blocks.
>
> Do you know what Paul and Silas did at midnight? They prayed and sang songs to God! The other prisoners were listening. Suddenly — RUMBLE! — a huge earthquake shook the jail. All the doors flew open, and everyone's chains came loose!
>
> The jailer woke up and thought all the prisoners had escaped. He was terrified. But Paul shouted, "Don't harm yourself! We are all here!" The jailer rushed in, shaking, and fell down before them. "Sirs, what must I do to be saved?"

> They answered, "Believe in the Lord Jesus, and you will be saved — you and your household." That very night, the jailer and his whole family believed and were baptized, and he was filled with joy!
>
> Years later, Paul was arrested in Jerusalem. He asked to have his case heard by Caesar, the emperor in Rome. So soldiers put Paul on a ship. But a terrible storm blew for two weeks. The sailors threw cargo overboard. Everyone thought they would die. Then Paul stood up and said, "Keep up your courage! An angel of God told me that not one of you will be lost — only the ship."
>
> The ship crashed on the island of Malta and broke apart. But all 276 people made it safely to shore! While Paul was building a fire, a poisonous snake bit his hand. Everyone waited for him to fall over — but Paul just shook it off into the fire and was fine!
>
> Finally Paul reached Rome. He was under guard in a house for two years, but people came to visit him every day. And the book of Acts ends with Paul telling everyone about Jesus "with all boldness and without hindrance." The good news was unstoppable — and it still is! Now it has reached all the way to us.

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Play "jail": sit with "chained" hands (crossed wrists). Sing "Jesus Loves Me" softly, then stomp feet for the earthquake and throw hands apart — "Free!" Then rock side to side for the storm.
- **Explorers:** Let them shout the sound effects: RUMBLE! CRASH! HISS (snake)! Give each child a "ticket" for each city visited and stamp it.
- **Trailblazers:** Trace the three journeys on the map. Find Philippi, Ephesus, Corinth, and Rome — and connect: "Paul later wrote letters to these very churches!" (Next month's books.)
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss Acts 17:16–34 (Paul in Athens with philosophers). How did Paul start with what they knew ("an unknown god") to point them to Jesus? Practice explaining the gospel in 60 seconds to a friend who doesn't go to church.

Discussion questions

- *Little Lambs:* 1) What did Paul and Silas do in jail? (Sang and prayed!) 2) What shook the jail? (An earthquake.) 3) What bit Paul? (A snake — and he was okay!)
- *Explorers:* 1) What question did the jailer ask? 2) How many people were on Paul's ship, and how many were saved? 3) Why do you think Paul and Silas could sing in a dark jail?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) Why do you think God let Paul go through so many hard things? 2) How did Paul encourage others during the storm? 3) Acts ends without telling us what happened to Paul at his trial. Why might Luke end it there?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) Acts ends "without hindrance" while Paul is literally in chains. What's the point? 2) Where are "the ends of the earth" for you — who near you hasn't heard about Jesus? 3) How do you answer someone who says, "If God loved Paul, why did he suffer so much?"

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "Paul and Silas" / "Paul shipwreck" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Paul+and+Silas | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Paul shipwreck" / "Paul missionary journey" |

https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Paul+shipwreck | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | "Overview: Acts 13–28" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Acts+13-28 |

Teacher: Preview every video before class. Follow-up questions: 1) What did the jailer do after he believed? 2) How did God protect Paul on the way to Rome?

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Shipwreck!* (see Games). ✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Missionary Journey Map & Passport* (see Activities & Crafts). 🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** Say the full verse for the class; Little Lambs say "You will be my witnesses." Big kids: all 44 books in order, with section shouts. 🙏 **Closing prayer:**

> "God, nothing can stop Your good news! Thank You that it reached me. Help me share it with my friends and family. Amen."

Week 5 (optional) — Review & Fun Sunday

Use the End-of-Phase Review plan below: trivia ship race, oral check-offs, Bible Passport stamps, and the Spirit Flame badge.

Book Memory Song & Motions

🎵 New verse for Acts — tune: *"The Farmer in the Dell"*

> *🎵 The church is on the move, The church is on the move, Matthew, Mark, and Luke and John, And then comes ACTS — let's go!*
>
> *The Spirit came like fire, The Spirit came like fire, Jerusalem to all the world — That's the book of ACTS!*

🎵 The Cumulative Book Chant (Books 1–44)

Chant it with a steady clap-clap-slap (clap, clap, slap knees) rhythm. Each section ends with a "Section Shout." (Classes may also sing each section to the tune they learned in that phase — see the Memory System.)

> **OLD TESTAMENT!** *(arms wide like an open book)*
>
> Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy — **"FIVE books of LAW!"** *(hold up 5 fingers)*
>
> Joshua, Judges, Ruth, First and Second Samuel, First and Second Kings, First and Second Chronicles, Ezra, Nehemiah, Esther — **"TWELVE books of HISTORY!"** *(flash 10 + 2 fingers)*

> Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs — **"FIVE books of POETRY!"** *(strum an air harp)*
>
> Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, Daniel — **"FIVE MAJOR PROPHETS!"** *(big muscle arms)*
>
> Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah, Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah, Malachi — **"TWELVE MINOR PROPHETS!"** *(small muscle with one pinky)*
>
> **"THIRTY-NINE in the OLD!"** *(stomp, stomp)*
>
> **NEW TESTAMENT!** *(arms wide again)*
>
> Matthew, Mark, Luke, John — **"FOUR GOSPELS — JESUS' STORY!"** *(make a cross with fingers)*
>
> ACTS! — **"ONE book of HISTORY — THE CHURCH IS BORN!"** *(flame fingers, then throw hands out)*
>
> **"FORTY-FOUR and COUNTING!"** *(jump!)*

Hand motions (New Testament so far)

For Matthew, Mark, Luke and John, use the motions your class learned in Phase 9. For Genesis through Malachi, use the motions from Phases 1–8 (see the Memory System). This month adds one:

Book	Motion
Acts	Flame fingers over your head, then throw both hands forward ("GO!").

Section Shout

Teacher: "How many books of New Testament History?" **Kids:** "ONE BOOK — ACTS! THE CHURCH IS BORN!"

Cumulative recall drill (5 minutes)

1. **Echo round:** Teacher says each section; kids echo.
2. **Section sprint:** Teacher calls a section name ("Major Prophets!"), kids chant only those books.
3. **What comes next?:** Teacher says a book ("John!"), kids shout the next ("ACTS!"). Mix from all 44.
4. **Silent motions:** Do only the hand motions for the New Testament; kids name the book.
5. **Beat the clock:** Can the class chant all 44 in under 60 seconds?

Tips for each age group

- **Little Lambs:** Focus on the New Testament five (Matthew, Mark, Luke, John, Acts) with motions; join in the Section Shouts for the Old Testament.
- **Explorers:** Aim for all 44 with the chant; use colored section cards to help.
- **Trailblazers:** Say all 44 without help, and name where each section starts.

- **Ambassadors:** Lead the chant for younger groups; try it backward from Acts to Genesis!

Spelling & Reading

Spelling lists by age group

Little Lambs (letter recognition & sound it out)

- Find the first letter: **A** for Acts, **F** for Fire, **W** for Wind, **J** for Jesus, **P** for Peter and Paul.
- Sound it out: A-C-T-S ("a... k... t... s" — Acts!).
- Trace the word **ACTS** in large dotted letters on the printable.

Explorers (book names & story words)

- Acts, Matthew, Mark, Luke, John (review), Peter, Paul, Spirit, church, apostle

Trailblazers (book names + 5 vocab words)

- All New Testament books so far: Matthew, Mark, Luke, John, Acts
- Vocab: **Pentecost** (Jewish festival 50 days after Passover, when the Spirit came), **apostle** (one sent out by Jesus), **witness** (someone who tells what they saw), **missionary** (one sent to share the gospel), **ascension** (Jesus going up to heaven)

Ambassadors (book names + harder vocab with definitions)

- All 44 books so far, including Ecclesiastes, Lamentations, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Deuteronomy
- **persecution** — mistreating people because of what they believe
- **Gentile** — a person who is not Jewish
- **conversion** — turning from sin to follow Jesus; a changed life
- **martyr** — a person who dies because of their faith (from Greek *martys*, "witness")
- **Theophilus** — the person Luke wrote to; the name means "friend of God"

The syllable-clap method

1. Say the word slowly.
2. Clap once for each syllable: *Acts* (1 clap) · *A-pos-tle* (3 claps) · *Pen-te-cost* (3 claps) · *Mis-sion-ar-y* (4 claps) · *Per-se-cu-tion* (4 claps).
3. Spell each syllable, then put it together.

"Spell It Out" relay

Supplies: Large letter cards (one letter per card) for several words, two baskets, masking tape start line.

1. Divide into two teams. Put the scrambled letters for one word in each team's basket across the room.
2. Teacher calls a word (e.g., "APOSTLE"). One player at a time runs, grabs one correct letter, and runs back.

3. The team lines up their letters in order on the floor. First team to spell it correctly and read it aloud wins a point.
4. Little Lambs pair with an older buddy; Ambassadors spell harder words ("PERSECUTION").

Mini spelling bee word list

Word	Use it in a sentence
Acts	"Acts tells how the church began."
Spirit	"The Holy Spirit came on Pentecost."
Peter	"Peter preached and three thousand people believed."
Paul	"Paul traveled to many cities to tell about Jesus."
church	"The church is God's family, not just a building."
apostle	"An apostle is someone sent out by Jesus."
witness	"Jesus said, 'You will be my witnesses.'"
Pentecost	"The Spirit came with wind and fire at Pentecost."
missionary	"Paul was a missionary who sailed across the sea."
Damascus	"Saul met Jesus on the road to Damascus."
Jerusalem	"The church started in Jerusalem."
shipwreck	"Everyone survived the shipwreck on Malta."
persecution	"Persecution made the believers scatter, and they shared Jesus everywhere."
Gentile	"Cornelius was a Gentile who believed in Jesus."

Read-aloud practice passage

(Explorers and older read aloud; Little Lambs repeat key phrases.)

> **Acts 2:42–47 (simplified):** The believers listened to the apostles' teaching. They spent time together, ate meals together, and prayed together. Everyone was amazed at the wonders God did. They shared what they had with anyone who needed it. Every day they met together and praised God with glad and sincere hearts. And every day the Lord added more people who were being saved.

Word Trivia

⭐ Easy (Little Lambs / Explorers)

1. Where did Jesus go in Acts chapter 1?
2. Who did Jesus send to help His friends?

3. What did the sound at Pentecost sound like?
4. What did the flames look like they were resting on?
5. True or False: Peter and John gave the man at the gate lots of money.
6. What did the man who couldn't walk do after he was healed?
7. What did Paul and Silas do in jail at midnight?
8. What shook the jail?
9. What animal bit Paul on the island?
10. Fill in the blank: "You will be my _____." (Acts 1:8)

⭐⭐ Medium (Explorers / Trailblazers)

11. Who wrote the book of Acts?
12. How many days did Jesus spend with His friends after He rose, before going to heaven?
13. About how many people believed and were baptized at Pentecost?
14. Who said it? "Silver or gold I do not have, but what I do have I give you."
15. What was the name of the gate where the lame man sat?
16. Who was the first Christian to die for Jesus?
17. Which book? The church is born and the good news spreads to Rome.
18. What was Saul's other name?
19. Who did God send to pray for Saul so he could see again?
20. How did Saul escape from Damascus?
21. Who said it? "Sirs, what must I do to be saved?"
22. What did Lydia sell?
23. True or False: Everyone on Paul's ship survived the shipwreck.
24. On what island did Paul's ship crash?

⭐⭐⭐ Hard (Trailblazers / Ambassadors)

25. Who was chosen to replace Judas as one of the Twelve? (Acts 1)
26. To whom did Luke write both his Gospel and Acts?
27. Fill in the blank: "We cannot help speaking about what we have _____ and _____." (Acts 4:20)
28. Who said it? "Look, I see heaven open and the Son of Man standing at the right hand of God."
29. What book was the Ethiopian official reading when Philip met him?
30. In what city were the disciples first called "Christians"?
31. What was the name of the Roman centurion Peter visited in Acts 10?
32. Who answered the door when Peter knocked after escaping prison — and forgot to open it?
33. In which city were the people praised for examining the Scriptures every day? (Acts 17:11)
34. What did the altar in Athens say that Paul used to start his message?
35. How many people were on Paul's ship? (Acts 27:37)
36. Who fell asleep during Paul's long sermon and fell out of a window? (Acts 20)
37. True or False: Acts ends with Paul's death.
38. What were the three "rings" of Acts 1:8?

Answer key

1. Up to heaven. 2. The Holy Spirit. 3. A violent/rushing wind. 4. On each of them (their heads). 5. False — they had no money; they healed him in Jesus' name. 6. Walked, jumped, and praised God. 7. Prayed and sang hymns to God. 8. An earthquake. 9. A snake (viper). 10. witnesses.
2. Luke. 12. Forty days (Acts 1:3). 13. About 3,000 (Acts 2:41). 14. Peter (Acts 3:6). 15. Beautiful (Acts 3:2). 16. Stephen. 17. Acts. 18. Paul. 19. Ananias. 20. Lowered in a basket through an opening in the wall. 21. The Philippian jailer (Acts 16:30). 22. Purple cloth (Acts 16:14). 23. True (Acts 27:44). 24. Malta.
3. Matthias (Acts 1:26). 26. Theophilus. 27. seen; heard. 28. Stephen (Acts 7:56). 29. Isaiah (Acts 8:28–32, Isaiah 53). 30. Antioch (Acts 11:26). 31. Cornelius. 32. Rhoda (Acts 12:13–14). 33. Berea (Bereans). 34. "To an unknown god" (Acts 17:23). 35. 276. 36. Eutychus (Acts 20:9–12) — Paul brought him back to life. 37. False — it ends with Paul preaching in Rome under house arrest. 38. Jerusalem; Judea and Samaria; the ends of the earth.

Games

🎮 1. Wind Relay

- **Best for:** All ages (great for Little Lambs & Explorers)
- **Supplies:** Cotton balls or feather pieces, straws (one per child), masking tape, two paper "flame" targets
- **Setup:** Tape a start line and a finish line about 10–15 feet apart. Put a paper flame at the finish for each team.
- **How to play:** Teams line up. Each player blows a cotton ball through a straw from start to finish (no hands!), then runs back and tags the next player. While waiting, the team chants the New Testament books.
- **How to win:** First team to have every player finish wins. Bonus point if the team can say Acts 1:8.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* blow with mouths (no straws) and shorten the distance. *Older:* blow the cotton ball around obstacles (cones = "the ends of the earth").
- **Learning goal:** We can't see wind, but we see what it does — like the Holy Spirit.

🎮 2. Silver & Gold Freeze

- **Best for:** Little Lambs & Explorers
- **Supplies:** Music player, worship song
- **Setup:** Kids sit on the floor as the "man who couldn't walk."
- **How to play:** Teacher (as Peter) says, "Silver or gold I do not have..." Kids stay seated. When the teacher says "...In the name of Jesus — WALK!" everyone jumps up and walks/leaps/dances while music plays. When the music stops, freeze! Teacher calls out a book name; frozen kids must shout the book that comes after it (or before it for older kids).
- **How to win:** Everyone who answers stays in; last few standing are "Brave Witnesses."
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* just freeze and say "Thank You, Jesus!" *Older:* name the section of the called book too.

- **Learning goal:** Healing came through Jesus' name; book-order recall.

🎮 3. Road to Damascus Blindfold Walk

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers, Ambassadors
- **Supplies:** Blindfolds (or kids close eyes), cones/chairs for an obstacle path, a "Damascus" sign
- **Setup:** Make a winding path from "Jerusalem" to "Damascus."
- **How to play:** Pairs: one is "Saul" (blindfolded), one is a guide who leads only with words (or by holding a hand for younger kids). At each cone, Saul must say one book of the Bible in order (starting from Genesis) before taking the next step. At Damascus, the guide (as "Ananias") says "Brother Saul, receive your sight!" and removes the blindfold. Switch roles.
- **How to win:** Time each pair; fastest correct run wins — but no skipping books!
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* hold hands; just say "Jesus loves me" at each cone. *Older:* say the books backward from Acts.
- **Learning goal:** Saul's blindness and healing; trusting a guide; recall of book order.

🎮 4. Shipwreck!

- **Best for:** All ages
- **Supplies:** Open space, four signs on walls: "BOW" (front), "STERN" (back), "PORT" (left), "STARBOARD" (right)
- **How to play:** Teacher is "Captain." Commands: "Bow!" "Stern!" "Port!" "Starboard!" (run to that wall). "STORM!" (everyone spins in place). "Throw the cargo!" (pretend to toss boxes). "Snake!" (shake your hand off like Paul). "SHIPWRECK!" — everyone must find a group of exactly the number the captain calls ("Shipwreck — groups of 4!") and sit down in a "lifeboat." Each lifeboat must then shout one book from the New Testament.
- **How to win:** Kids left out of a group or too slow help the Captain give the next command (no one is ever really "out" — Acts 27: everyone was saved!).
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* fewer commands; just Storm, Snake, and Shipwreck. *Older:* lifeboats must recite the whole Gospels + Acts or a section of the Old Testament.
- **Learning goal:** Paul's shipwreck story; God kept all 276 people safe.

🎮 5. Spread the Good News (Tag)

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers
- **Supplies:** Red pinnies or red bandanas (flames), open area
- **How to play:** Start with one "Witness" holding a red bandana (the Spirit's flame). When the Witness tags someone, they must say a book of the Bible (in order — the class keeps track), and then that person gets a bandana and becomes a Witness too. Keep going until everyone is a Witness. Like the church in Acts, the good news spreads person to person!
- **How to win:** Last person tagged gets to start the next round. Challenge: get through all 44 books before everyone is tagged.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* walk instead of run; say "Jesus loves you!" when tagging. *Older:* add "zones" (Jerusalem, Judea/Samaria, the ends of the earth) that must be reached in order.
- **Learning goal:** Acts 1:8 — the message spreads outward; book-order recall.

🎮 6. Acts Trivia Ship Race (Review Sunday)

- **Best for:** All ages, in mixed teams
- **Supplies:** Map of the Mediterranean drawn on poster board with a path of 10 spaces from Jerusalem to Rome, paper boat markers for each team, trivia questions from above
- **How to play:** Teams take turns answering trivia. Easy = move 1 space, Medium = 2, Hard = 3. "Storm" cards (wrong answers) don't send you back — instead the team must say Acts 1:8 together to "stay afloat."
- **How to win:** First team to reach Rome!
- **Learning goal:** Review the whole book of Acts.

Coloring Pages

🖍️ **Coloring page 1 — Jesus Goes Up (Week 1)** *Scene:* Jesus rising into a soft cloud above a grassy hill (Mount of Olives); 11 disciples looking up with hands shading their eyes; two men in white standing nearby. *Caption:* "This same Jesus... will come back." — Acts 1:11 *Coloring conversation:* Where is Jesus now? What did the two men in white say? Is Jesus coming back?

🖍️ **Coloring page 2 — Wind & Fire (Week 1)** *Scene:* A room full of happy people with small flames above their heads; swirly lines for wind; a window showing a crowd outside from many lands. *Caption:* "All of them were filled with the Holy Spirit." — Acts 2:4 *Coloring conversation:* What color will you make the flames? Who lives in the hearts of people who trust Jesus?

🖍️ **Coloring page 3 — Walking & Jumping (Week 2)** *Scene:* A man leaping in the air with arms raised; Peter and John smiling; a big, decorated temple gate behind them. *Caption:* "In the name of Jesus Christ... walk." — Acts 3:6 *Coloring conversation:* How do you think he felt? What's something you can thank Jesus for today?

🖍️ **Coloring page 4 — The Light on the Road (Week 3)** *Scene:* Saul on the ground shielding his eyes from a bright beam from heaven; his traveling companions startled; the city of Damascus in the distance. *Caption:* "I am Jesus." — Acts 9:5 *Coloring conversation:* What was Saul like before? After? Who can Jesus change?

🖍️ **Coloring page 5 — Singing in Jail (Week 4)** *Scene:* Paul and Silas sitting in a stone jail with music notes floating up; chains falling open; cracks in the wall from an earthquake. *Caption:* "About midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing." — Acts 16:25 *Coloring conversation:* What song would you sing if you were scared? How can we praise God when things are hard?

🖍️ **Coloring page 6 — Book Name Page: ACTS** *Design:* Big bubble letters **A-C-T-S** filled with small pictures: a flame (A), a church (C), a ship (T), and a snake being shaken off (S). Border with "Matthew · Mark · Luke · John · ACTS." *Caption:* "Acts — The Church Is Born! Book 44 of 66."

> **Printable book-name coloring sheet and word search: see `../printables/phase-10-printables.html`**

Activities & Crafts

✂️ 1. Pentecost Flame Headbands (Week 1)

- **Supplies:** Sentence strips or paper strips (for headbands), red/orange/yellow tissue paper or construction paper, glue sticks, stapler, markers
- **Steps:** 1) Cut flame shapes from colored paper. 2) Write "ACTS 1:8" or "I can be a witness!" on the headband. 3) Glue flames to the front. 4) Staple to fit each child's head.
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* use pre-cut flames and stickers. *Explorers:* write the verse reference. *Trailblazers/Ambassadors:* write the names of the four "rings" (Jerusalem, Judea, Samaria, ends of the earth) on four flames.
- **What it teaches:** The Holy Spirit came on every believer; we are witnesses.

✂️ 2. "In Jesus' Name" Walking Feet Craft (Week 2)

- **Supplies:** Construction paper, crayons, scissors, glue, a long paper strip
- **Steps:** 1) Trace each child's feet on paper and cut out. 2) On one foot write "Walking," on the other "Jumping." 3) Glue to a strip that says "and praising God!" (Acts 3:8).
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* teachers trace and cut; kids color. *Explorers:* add Acts 3:6. *Older:* write one place their feet will go this week where they can be brave for Jesus.
- **What it teaches:** Jesus' power healed the man; we can walk in Jesus' name.

✂️ 3. Scales-Falling Paper Glasses (Week 3)

- **Supplies:** Paper glasses template (or pipe cleaners shaped as glasses), wax paper or cellophane, tape, sequins or paper "scales"
- **Steps:** 1) Make simple glasses frames. 2) Lightly tape paper "scales" over the lenses. 3) Retell the story; on "Brother Saul, receive your sight!" kids peel the scales off and look through clear lenses.
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* pre-made frames. *Older:* write "Before" and "After" words for Saul on each arm of the glasses.
- **What it teaches:** Jesus changed Saul; God opens our eyes to the truth.

✂️ 4. Missionary Journey Map & Passport (Week 4)

- **Supplies:** Printed outline map of the Mediterranean (or hand-drawn), colored yarn or markers, small booklet (folded paper), stamps or stickers
- **Steps:** 1) Mark Jerusalem, Antioch, Philippi, Athens, Corinth, Ephesus, Malta, Rome. 2) Glue yarn along Paul's route. 3) In a mini "passport," kids draw something that happened in each city (Philippi = jail, Malta = snake, Rome = house arrest). Stamp each page.
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* place stickers on a pre-drawn route. *Explorers:* label cities. *Trailblazers:* color-code the three journeys. *Ambassadors:* add the letters Paul later wrote to each city (Philippians, Corinthians, Ephesians, Thessalonians).
- **What it teaches:** The gospel spread "to the ends of the earth"; Acts connects to Paul's letters.

✂️ 5. "Unstoppable" Prayer Chain

- **Supplies:** Strips of paper, markers, tape or glue
- **Steps:** Each child writes or draws the name of someone they want to tell about Jesus, then links their strip to the class chain. Add to it every week. On Review Sunday, hang it around the room and pray over it.
- **Ages:** *Little Lambs:* draw a face. *Older:* write a name and one way to show them Jesus' love.
- **What it teaches:** We are witnesses; the church grows one person at a time.

✂️ 6. Shipwreck Snack (bonus)

- **Supplies:** Blue gelatin or blue frosting on graham crackers ("sea"), pretzel sticks (broken ship planks), gummy snakes, goldfish crackers. *(Check for allergies.)*
- **Steps:** Kids build the shipwreck scene and retell Acts 27–28 as they eat.
- **What it teaches:** God kept everyone safe; the snake couldn't hurt Paul.

Word Puzzles

Word scramble

Unscramble these Acts words:

1. TSAC
2. RTEEP
3. LUPA
4. TIRSIP
5. HCURHC
6. SWESSITNE
7. CTSOPEENT
8. LTEOPAS
9. SCUSAMAD
10. KRCEWHSIP
11. ALAMT
12. YLAID
13. NGIISGN
14. LTEIENG

Answer key: 1. ACTS 2. PETER 3. PAUL 4. SPIRIT 5. CHURCH 6. WITNESSES 7. PENTECOST 8. APOSTLE 9. DAMASCUS 10. SHIPWRECK 11. MALTA 12. LYDIA 13. SINGING 14. GENTILE

Fill-in-the-blank story

Word bank: heaven, Spirit, fire, Peter, three thousand, walk, Saul, blind, Paul, sang, earthquake, Rome

> After Jesus rose again, He went up to _____. Then the Holy _____ came with wind and tongues of _____. _____ preached, and about _____ _____ people believed. Peter and John told a man to _____ in Jesus' name. A man named _____ hated Christians, but Jesus met him on the road and he was _____ for three days. Later he was called _____. He and Silas _____ in jail, and an _____ shook the doors open! At the end of Acts, Paul was in _____ telling everyone about Jesus.

Answers: heaven, Spirit, fire, Peter, three thousand, walk, Saul, blind, Paul, sang, earthquake, Rome

Match the story to its picture

Draw a line from each story to its picture symbol. | Story | Picture | |---|---| | 1. Jesus goes up to heaven | A. 🐍 Snake shaken into a fire | | 2. Pentecost | B. 🧺 Basket over a wall | | 3. The lame man healed | C. ☁️ A cloud | | 4. Saul escapes Damascus | D. 🔥 Flames and wind | | 5. Paul and Silas in jail | E. 🦶 Jumping feet | | 6. Malta | F. 🎵 Music notes and chains | | 7. Peter's vision | G. 🧺 A big sheet full of animals |

Answers: 1-C, 2-D, 3-E, 4-B, 5-F, 6-A, 7-G

Bonus — Match the book to its summary (review): | Book | Summary | |---|---| | Matthew | a. A doctor's careful account of Jesus' life | | Mark | b. Jesus is the promised King from David's line | | Luke | c. Jesus is God's Son — believe and have life | | John | d. The church is born and the good news spreads | | Acts | e. The fast-moving story of Jesus the Servant |

Answers: Matthew-b, Mark-e, Luke-a, John-c, Acts-d

Questions for Every Age

Little Lambs (ages 4–6)

1. Who lives in the hearts of people who love Jesus?
2. What is the church? (God's family!)
3. Who can you tell about Jesus this week?
4. What makes you brave?
5. How can you help someone like Peter and John helped the man?

Explorers (ages 7–10)

1. How would you explain the Holy Spirit to a friend?
2. When is it hard for you to talk about Jesus?
3. Which person in Acts would you most like to meet, and why?
4. What do you think the first church was like? Would you like it?
5. Paul and Silas sang when things were bad. What can you do when you're having a bad day?

Trailblazers (ages 11–13)

1. What does it mean to "be filled with the Spirit" in everyday life?
2. How did persecution actually help the church grow?
3. Why did God choose someone like Saul to be His messenger?
4. How do you know if you're part of God's church?
5. What's one "Jerusalem" (home), "Judea" (town), and "ends of the earth" (world) where you can be a witness?

Ambassadors (ages 14–17)

1. How does the church in Acts 2:42–47 challenge the way we "do church" today?
2. What makes a person bold for Jesus — personality, or something else?
3. How do you share your faith with someone who has a different religion, like Paul did in Athens?
4. Christians are still persecuted in many countries. How should we respond and pray?
5. How can you use your gifts in your church right now, not "someday"?

🧠 Big Questions for Ambassadors (apologetics & worldview)

1. **"How do we know the resurrection really happened — wasn't it just made up later?"** *Suggested answer:* Acts shows the apostles preaching the resurrection in Jerusalem within weeks — the very city where Jesus' tomb was. If the body were still there, opponents could have produced it. The disciples went from hiding to boldly risking prison and death; people don't usually die for something they know is a lie. Paul, a former enemy, became a believer after meeting the risen Jesus. Early sources (like 1 Corinthians 15:3–8) list many eyewitnesses.
2. **"Is Acts real history, or just a religious story?"** *Suggested answer:* Luke names real rulers (Herod Agrippa, Gallio, Felix, Festus, King Agrippa II), cities, and local titles that historians and archaeologists have confirmed (for example, the Gallio inscription at Delphi helps date Paul's time in Corinth). Luke says he carefully investigated (Luke 1:1–4) and was present for parts of the journey ("we" passages). That doesn't prove every miracle by itself, but it shows Luke was a careful, trustworthy historian.
3. **"Isn't it arrogant to say everyone needs Jesus?"** *Suggested answer:* Peter said salvation is found in no one else (Acts 4:12), but the message was offered humbly and freely to everyone — Jews, Samaritans, Ethiopians, Romans, Greeks. The gospel isn't "we're better than you"; it's "we were all lost, and Jesus rescues anyone who trusts Him." Sharing good news you believe is true is an act of love, not arrogance.

End-of-Phase Review & Celebration

Review game plan (last Sunday)

Time	Activity
10 min	Welcome + full Cumulative Book Chant (all 44) with motions
15 min	🎮 Acts Trivia Ship Race (mixed-age teams)
10 min	Replay a favorite video clip; kids vote

Time	Activity
15 min	Oral check-offs (rotating stations with helpers; Ambassadors assist)
15 min	Shipwreck Snack + finish passports & prayer chain
10 min	Badge ceremony, Bible Passport stamps, prayer

Oral check-off checklist

Little Lambs

- [ ] Says the Little Lambs verse: "You will be my witnesses."
- [ ] Says the section name: "Acts — the church is born!"
- [ ] Names 3 New Testament books (e.g., Matthew, Mark, Acts) with motions
- [ ] Tells one thing from Acts (wind and fire, walking man, singing in jail, snake...)

Explorers

- [ ] Says Acts 1:8 (with help allowed on the place names)
- [ ] Says and spells A-C-T-S
- [ ] Says all 5 New Testament books so far in order and spells each
- [ ] Says the Old Testament section names in order

Trailblazers

- [ ] Says Acts 1:8 from memory
- [ ] Says all 44 books in order (two "helps" allowed)
- [ ] Gives a one-sentence summary for each New Testament book so far
- [ ] Names Paul's three missionary journeys' main cities on a map (at least 4)

Ambassadors

- [ ] Says Acts 1:8 and explains how it outlines the book
- [ ] Says all 44 books in order with no help
- [ ] Teaches the story of Acts (in 2–3 minutes) to a younger kid, using the Flame & Go motion
- [ ] Explains one Big Question in their own words

🛂 Bible Passport stamp

Stamp: a **red flame over a small globe** with the words "ACTS — BOOK 44."

🏅 Badge description — The Spirit Flame

A round red-and-orange badge with a flame in the center. Inside the flame is a small globe showing the Mediterranean. Around the edge: "THE CHURCH IS BORN · ACTS 1:8 · 44 of 66."

📜 Certificate wording

> **Purpose Church Sunday School Bible Explorer Certificate — Phase 10: The Church Is Born**
>
> This certifies that _____ has learned the book of **ACTS** and can say the books of the Bible from **Genesis to Acts — 44 of 66!**
>
> "You will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you; and you will be my witnesses… to the ends of the earth." — Acts 1:8
>
> Awarded the **Spirit Flame Badge** on _____ (date).
>
> Teacher: _____

Take-Home Family Page

Dear Parents and Families,

This month your child learned about the book of **Acts** — how Jesus went back to heaven, sent the Holy Spirit at Pentecost, and how the first Christians (like Peter and Paul) bravely shared the good news from Jerusalem to Rome. Your child can now say **44 of the 66 books** of the Bible! Please ask them to teach you the chant and motions.

This month's verse: "But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you; and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth." — Acts 1:8
Little Lambs: "You will be my witnesses."

🎵 **This month's song** (tune: *The Farmer in the Dell*):

> The church is on the move, the church is on the move, Matthew, Mark, and Luke and John, and then comes ACTS — let's go!

🍽️ **Dinner-table questions**

1. What happened on the day of Pentecost?
2. How did Jesus change Saul? Can Jesus change anyone?
3. Who is one person our family could tell about Jesus, or show His love to, this week?

🏠 **Family activity — "Our Family's Acts 1:8 Map"** Draw four circles inside each other. In the center write "Our Home," then "Our Neighborhood," then "Our City," then "The World." Together, write one way your family can share Jesus' love in each circle (e.g., pray at dinner, bake cookies for a neighbor, help at a food pantry, pray for or support a missionary). Put it on the fridge!

📺 **Videos to watch at home** (search on YouTube; parents, please preview):

- **@SharefaithKids** — search "Pentecost" or "Paul and Silas": https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Pentecost
- **@BibleJourneyTV** — search "Paul shipwreck": https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Paul+shipwreck
- **@bibleproject** — "Overview: Acts 1–12" and "Overview: Acts 13–28" (best for ages 11+): https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Overview+Acts

Next month: "Letters from Paul" — 13 letters Paul wrote to churches and friends!